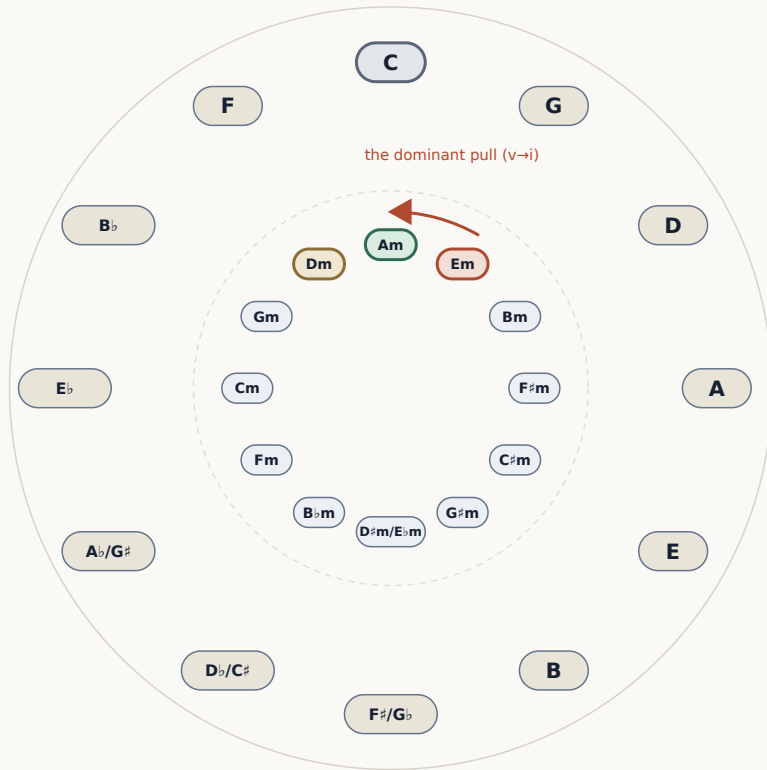


Chord progressions in A minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of A minor is highlighted.

Diatonic chords in A minor

Functions: **i** · **iv**/VI · **v** · III

i · Am tonic	ii° · Bdim side	III · C rel. major	iv · Dm subdom.	v · Em minor dom.	VI · F subdom.	VII · G side
Am i · tonic	Bdim ii° · skip it take iv instead: Dm	C III · rel. major	Dm iv · subdom.	Em v · minor dom.	F VI · subdom.	G VII · side

the V7 pull (harmonic minor)
shape: 020100

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in A minor)

i - VI - III - VII

Am - F - C - G

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

Am - Dm - E7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

Am - G - F - E

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

Am - G - F - Em

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

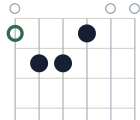
Am - C - G - F

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

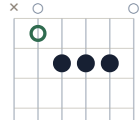
Am7	Am7	Am7	Am7	Dm7	Dm7	Am7	Am7	E7	Dm7	Am7	E7
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Transposing on the guitar: one barre shape, any key



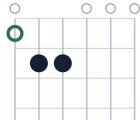
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



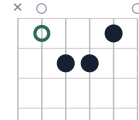
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

How to read it: a barre = one finger across all strings,
at the chosen fret — the shape stays, only the position changes.

The green ring marks where the tonic sits (the chord's name).

Progressions work in EVERY minor key — you shift them along the circle:

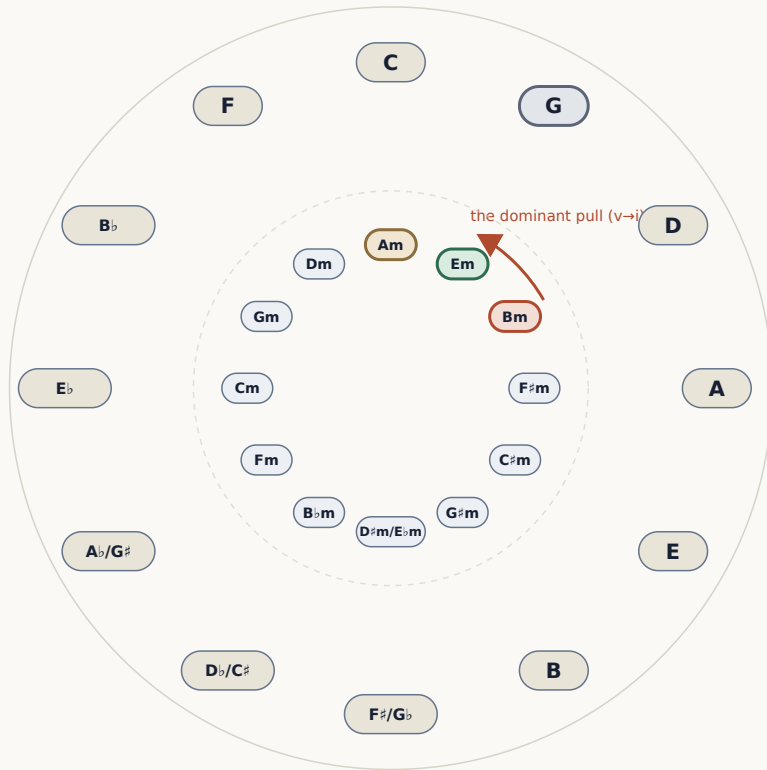
e.g. a-F-C-G (Am-F-C-G) → E minor: Em-C-G-D.

Functions: **i** tonic · **iv**/VI subdominant · **v** dominant

III the major sibling — the notes change, not the roles.

Chord progressions in E minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of E minor is highlighted.

Diatonic chords in E minor

Functions: i · iv/VI · v · III

i · Em tonic	ii° · F#dim side	III · G rel. major	iv · A subdom.	v · Bm minor dom.	VI · C subdom.	VII · D side
Em i · tonic	F#dim ii° · skip it take iv instead: A	G III · rel. major	A iv · subdom.	Bm v · minor dom.	C VI · subdom.	D VII · side

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in E minor)

i - VI - III - VII

Em - C - G - D

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

Em - A - B7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

Em - D - C - B

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

Em - D - C - Bm

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

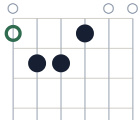
Em - G - D - C

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

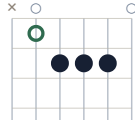
Em7	Em7	Em7	Em7	A7	A7	Em7	Em7	B7	A7	Em7	B7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



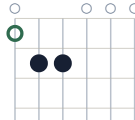
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



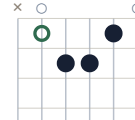
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of E minor:

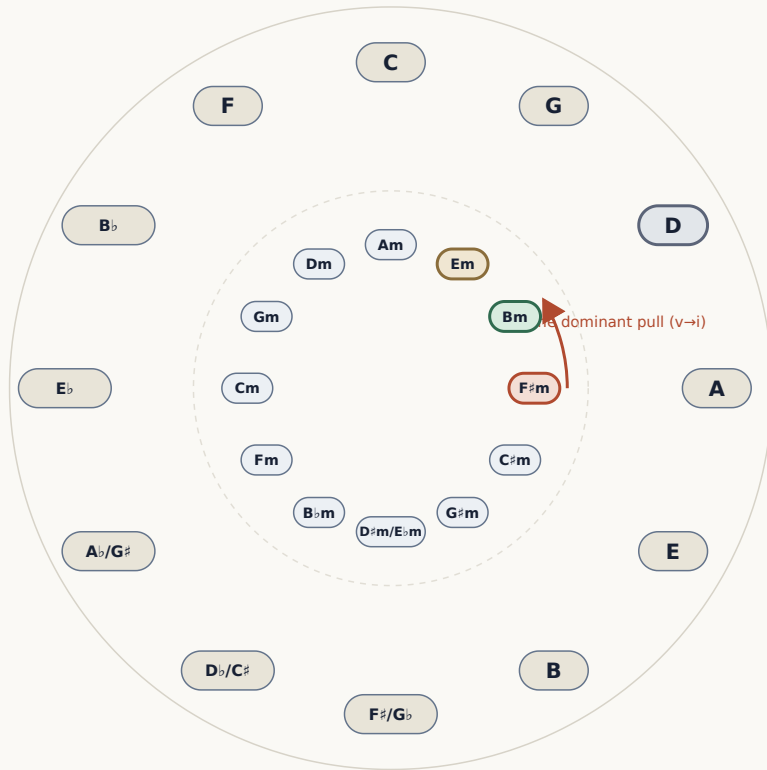
All open shapes except Bm

(barre at fret 2) — otherwise capo 2 + A-minor shapes (Am→Bm, Dm→Em, C→D, G→A, Em→F#m)

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

Chord progressions in B minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of B minor is highlighted.

Diatonic chords in B minor

Functions: i · iv/vi · v · III

i · Bm tonic	ii° · C#dim side	III · D rel. major	iv · Em subdom.	v · F#m minor dom.	VI · G subdom.	VII · A side
 Bm i · tonic	 C#dim ii° · skip it take iv instead: Em	 D III · rel. major	 Em iv · subdom.	 F#m v · minor dom.	 G VI · subdom.	 A VII · side

the V7 pull (harmonic minor)
shape: 242322

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in B minor)

i - VI - III - VII

Bm - G - D - A

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

Bm - Em - F#7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

Bm - A - G - F#

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

Bm - A - G - F#m

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

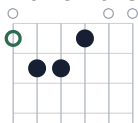
Bm - D - A - G

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

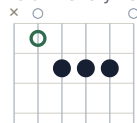
Bm7	Bm7	Bm7	Bm7	Em7	Em7	Bm7	Bm7	F#7	Em7	Bm7	F#7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



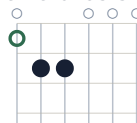
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



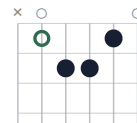
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of B minor:

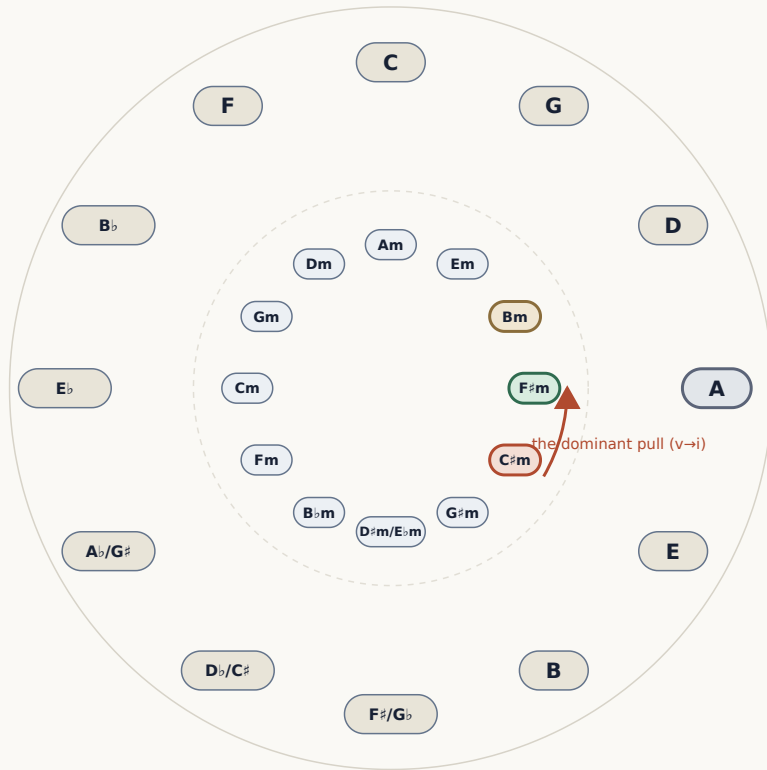
capo 2 + A minor shapes

(Am→Bm, Dm→Em, Em→F#m, F→G, C→D, G→A).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

Chord progressions in F# minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of F# minor is highlighted.

Diatonic chords in F# minor

Functions: i · iv/vi · v · III

i · F#m tonic	ii° · G#dim side	III · A rel. major	iv · B subdom.	v · C#m minor dom.	VI · D subdom.	VII · E side
F#m i · tonic	G#dim ii° · skip it take iv instead: B	A III · rel. major	B iv · subdom.	C#m v · minor dom.	D VI · subdom.	E VII · side

the V7 pull (harmonic minor)
shape: x46464

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in F# minor)

i - VI - III - VII

F#m - D - A - E

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

F#m - B - C#7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

F#m - E - D - C#

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

F#m - E - D - C#m

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

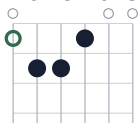
F#m - A - E - D

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

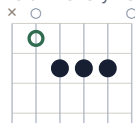
F#m7	F#m7	F#m7	F#m7	B7	B7	F#m7	F#m7	C#7	B7	F#m7	C#7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



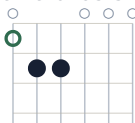
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



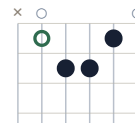
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of F# minor:

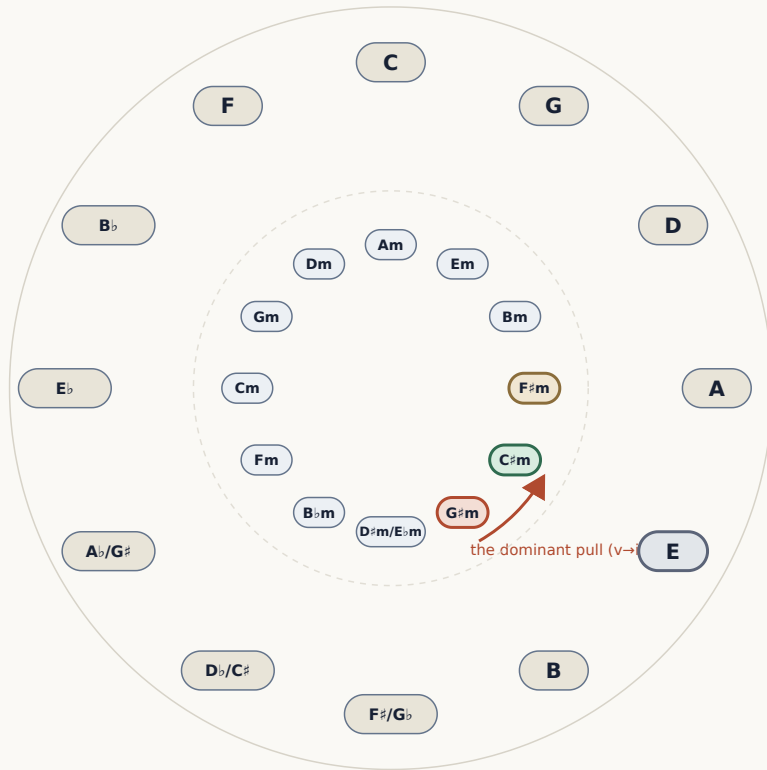
capo 2 + E minor shapes

(Em→F#m, G→A, A→B, Bm→C#m, C→D, D→E).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

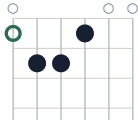
Chord progressions in C# minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



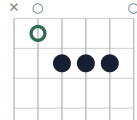
Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of C# minor is highlighted.

Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



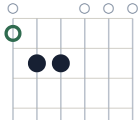
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



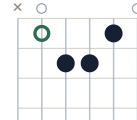
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

Diatonic chords in C# minor

Functions: i · iv/vi · v · III

i · C#m tonic	ii° · D#dim side	III · E rel. major	iv · F#m subdom.	v · G#m minor dom.	VI · A subdom.	VII · B side
C#m i · tonic	D#dim ii° · skip it take iv instead: F#m	E III · rel. major	F#m iv · subdom.	G#m v · minor dom.	A VI · subdom.	B VII · side

the V7 pull (harmonic minor)
shape: 464544

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in C# minor)

i - VI - III - VII

C#m - A - E - B

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

C#m - F#m - G#7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

C#m - B - A - G#

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

C#m - B - A - G#m

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

C#m - E - B - A

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

C#m7	C#m7	C#m7	C#m7	F#m7	F#m7	C#m7	C#m7	G#7	F#m7	C#m7	G#7
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The easiest way — the key of C# minor:

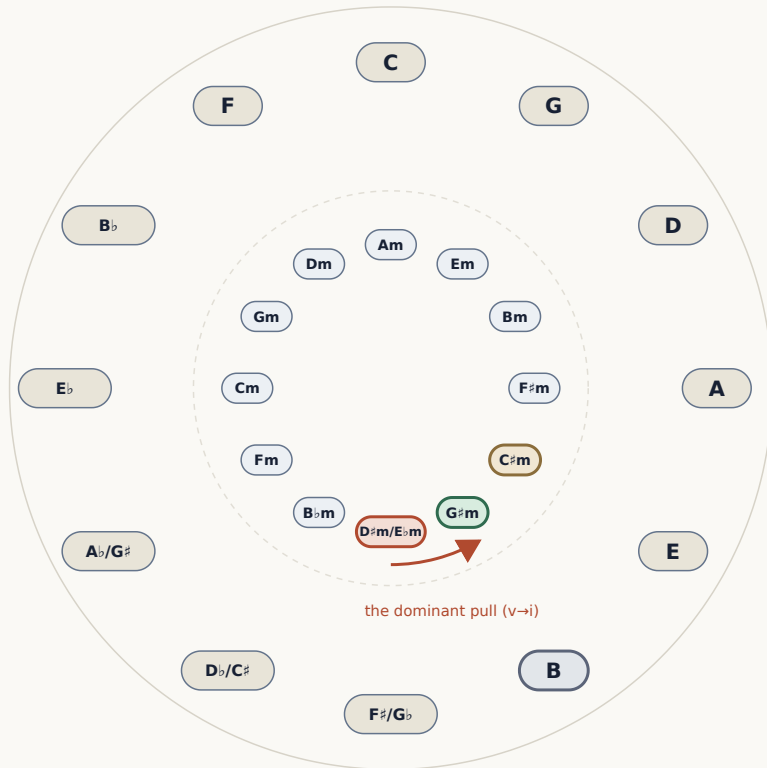
capo 4 + A minor shapes

(Am→C#m, Dm→F#m, Em→G#m, F→A, G→B, C→E).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

Chord progressions in G# minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of G# minor is highlighted.

Diatonic chords in G# minor

Functions: i · iv/vi · v · III

i · G#m tonic	ii° · A#dim side	III · B rel. major	iv · C#m subdom.	v · D#m minor dom.	VI · E subdom.	VII · F# side
G#m i · tonic	A#dim ii° · skip it take iv instead: C#m	B III · rel. major	C#m iv · subdom.	D#m v · minor dom.	E VI · subdom.	F# VII · side

the V7 pull (harmonic minor)
shape: x6866

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in G# minor)

i - VI - III - VII

G#m - E - B - F#

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

G#m - C#m - D#7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

G#m - F# - E - D#

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

G#m - F# - E - D#m

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

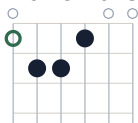
G#m - B - F# - E

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

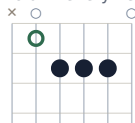
G#m7	G#m7	G#m7	G#m7	C#m7	C#m7	G#m7	G#m7	D#7	C#m7	G#m7	D#7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



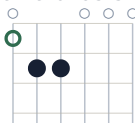
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



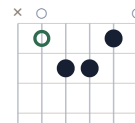
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of G# minor:

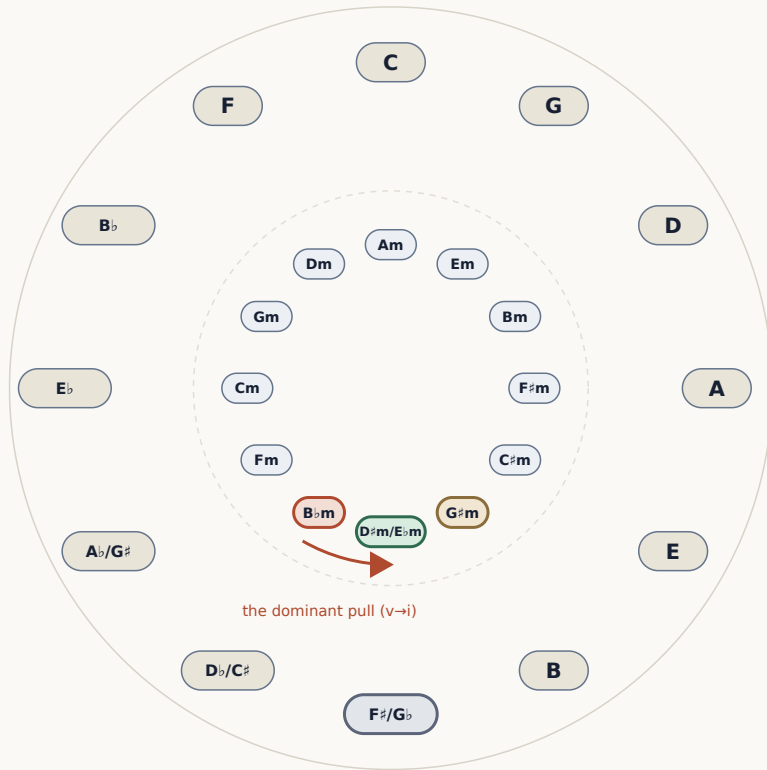
capo 4 + E minor shapes

(Em→G#m, G→B, A→C#, Bm→D#m, C→E, D→F#).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

Chord progressions in D# minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of D# minor is highlighted.

Diatonic chords in D# minor

Functions: i · iv/vi · v · III

i · D#m tonic	ii° · E#dim side	III · F# rel. major	iv · G#m subdom.	v · A#m minor dom.	VI · B subdom.	VII · C# side
D#m i · tonic	E#dim ii° · skip it take iv instead: G#m	F# III · rel. major	G#m iv · subdom.	A#m v · minor dom.	B VI · subdom.	C# VII · side

the V7 pull (harmonic minor)
shape: x13131

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in D# minor)

i - VI - III - VII

D#m - B - F# - C#

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

D#m - G#m - A#7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

D#m - C# - B - A#

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

D#m - C# - B - A#m

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

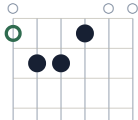
D#m - F# - C# - B

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

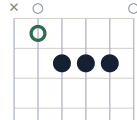
D#m7	D#m7	D#m7	D#m7	G#m7	G#m7	D#m7	D#m7	A#7	G#m7	D#m7	A#7
------	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	-----	------	------	-----

Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



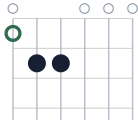
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



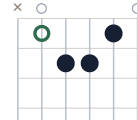
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of D# minor:

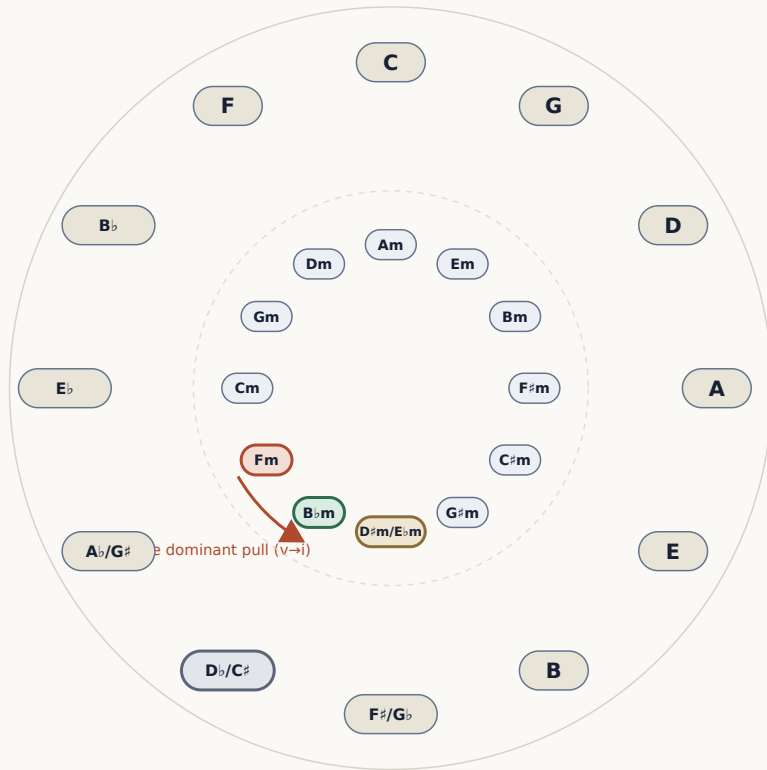
capo 6 + A minor shapes

(Am→D#m, Dm→G#m, Em→A#m, F→B, G→C#, C→F#).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

Chord progressions in B $\flat$ minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of B $\flat$ minor is highlighted.

Diatonic chords in B $\flat$ minor

Functions: i · iv/vi · v · III

i · B $\flat$ m tonic	ii $^\circ$ · Cdim side	III · D $\flat$ rel. major	iv · E $\flat$ m subdom.	v · Fm minor dom.	VI · G $\flat$ subdom.	VII · A $\flat$ side
B $\flat$ m i · tonic	Cdim ii $^\circ$ · skip it take iv instead: E $\flat$ m	D $\flat$ III · rel. major	E $\flat$ m iv · subdom.	Fm v · minor dom.	G $\flat$ VI · subdom.	A $\flat$ VII · side

the V7 pull (harmonic minor)
shape: 131211

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in B $\flat$ minor)

i - VI - III - VII

B $\flat$ m - G $\flat$ - D $\flat$ - A $\flat$

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

B $\flat$ m - E $\flat$ m - F7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

B $\flat$ m - A $\flat$ - G $\flat$ - F

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

B $\flat$ m - A $\flat$ - G $\flat$ - Fm

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

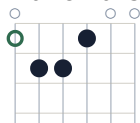
B $\flat$ m - D $\flat$ - A $\flat$ - G $\flat$

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

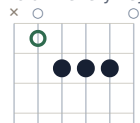
B $\flat$ m7	B $\flat$ m7	B $\flat$ m7	B $\flat$ m7	E $\flat$ m7	E $\flat$ m7	B $\flat$ m7	B $\flat$ m7	F7	E $\flat$ m7	B $\flat$ m7	F7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



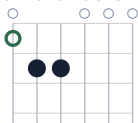
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



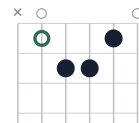
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of B $\flat$ minor:

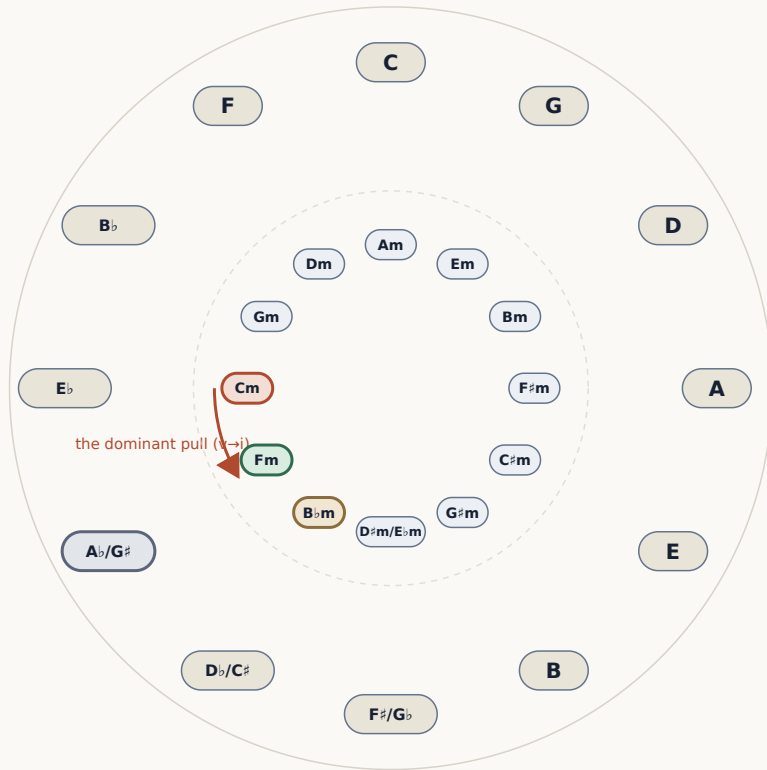
capo 1 + A minor shapes

(Am→B $\flat$ m, Dm→E $\flat$ m, Em→Fm, F→G $\flat$, G→A $\flat$, C→D $\flat$).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

Chord progressions in F minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of F minor is highlighted.

Diatonic chords in F minor

Functions: **i** · **iv**/**VI** · **v** · **III**

i · Fm tonic	ii° · Gdim side	III · A♭ rel. major	iv · B♭m subdom.	v · Cm minor dom.	VI · D♭ subdom.	VII · E♭ side
Fm i · tonic	Gdim ii° · skip it take iv instead: B♭m	A♭ III · rel. major	B♭m iv · subdom.	Cm v · minor dom.	D♭ VI · subdom.	E♭ VII · side

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in F minor)

i - VI - III - VII

Fm - D♭ - A♭ - E♭

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

Fm - B♭m - C7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

Fm - E♭ - D♭ - C

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

Fm - E♭ - D♭ - Cm

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

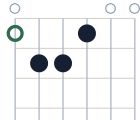
Fm - A♭ - E♭ - D♭

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

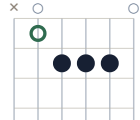
Fm7	Fm7	Fm7	Fm7	B♭m7	B♭m7	Fm7	Fm7	C7	B♭m7	Fm7	C7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



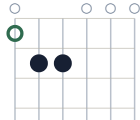
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



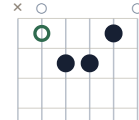
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F♯m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of F minor:

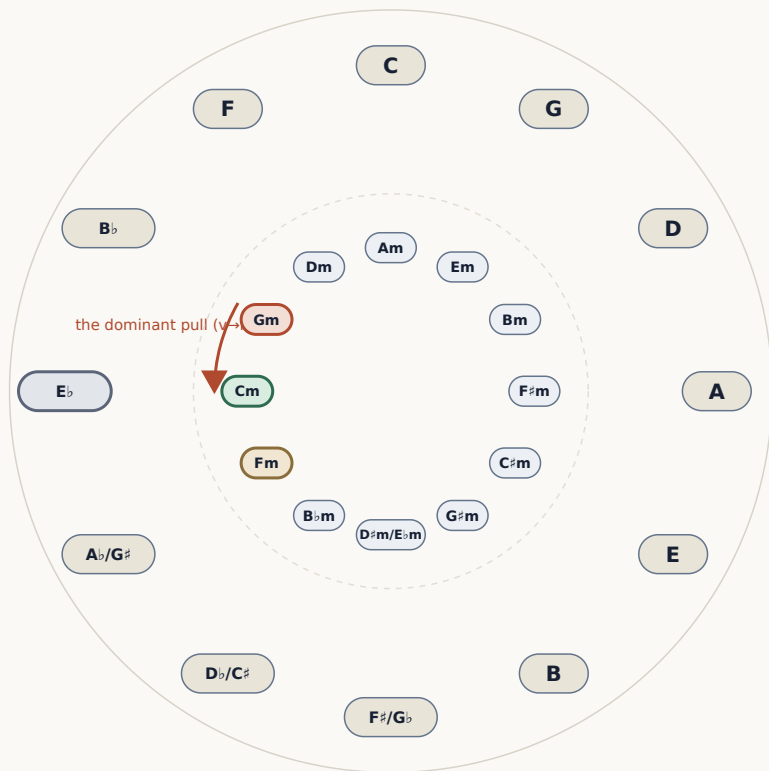
capo 1 + E minor shapes

(Em→Fm, G→A♭, A→B♭, Bm→Cm, C→D♭, D→E♭).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

Chord progressions in C minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of C minor is highlighted.

Diatonic chords in C minor

Functions: **i** · **iv**/**VI** · **v** · **III**

i · Cm tonic	ii° · Ddim side	III · Eb rel. major	iv · Fm subdom.	v · Gm minor dom.	VI · Ab subdom.	VII · Bb side
 i · tonic	 ii° · skip it take iv instead: Fm	 III · rel. major	 iv · subdom.	 v · minor dom.	 VI · subdom.	 VII · side

G7
the V7 pull (harmonic minor)
shape: 320001

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in C minor)

i - VI - III - VII

Cm - Ab - Eb - Bb

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

Cm - Fm - G7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

Cm - Bb - Ab - G

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

Cm - Bb - Ab - Gm

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

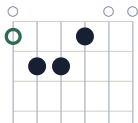
Cm - Eb - Bb - Ab

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

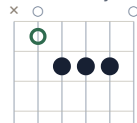
Cm7	Cm7	Cm7	Cm7	Fm7	Fm7	Cm7	Cm7	G7	Fm7	Cm7	G7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



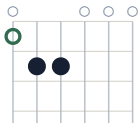
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



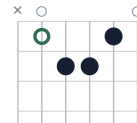
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of C minor:

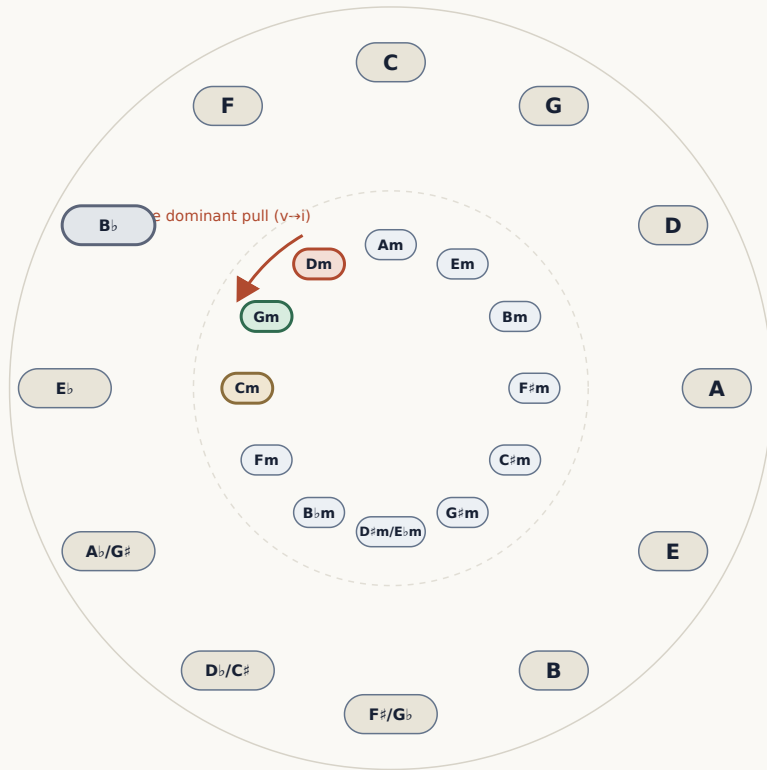
capo 3 + A minor shapes

(Am→Cm, Dm→Fm, Em→Gm, F→Ab, G→Bb, C→Eb).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

Chord progressions in G minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of G minor is highlighted.

Diatonic chords in G minor

Functions: i · iv/vi · v · III

i · Gm tonic	ii° · Adim side	III · Bb rel. major	iv · C subdom.	v · Dm minor dom.	VI · Eb subdom.	VII · F side
i · tonic	ii° · skip it take iv instead: C	III · rel. major	iv · subdom.	v · minor dom.	VI · subdom.	VII · side

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in G minor)

i - VI - III - VII

Gm - Eb - Bb - F

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

Gm - C - D7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - v

Gm - F - Eb - D

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

Gm - F - Eb - Dm

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

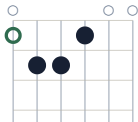
Gm - Bb - F - Eb

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

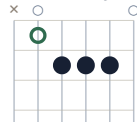
Gm7	Gm7	Gm7	Gm7	C7	C7	Gm7	Gm7	D7	C7	Gm7	D7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



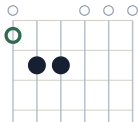
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



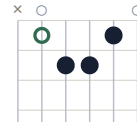
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of G minor:

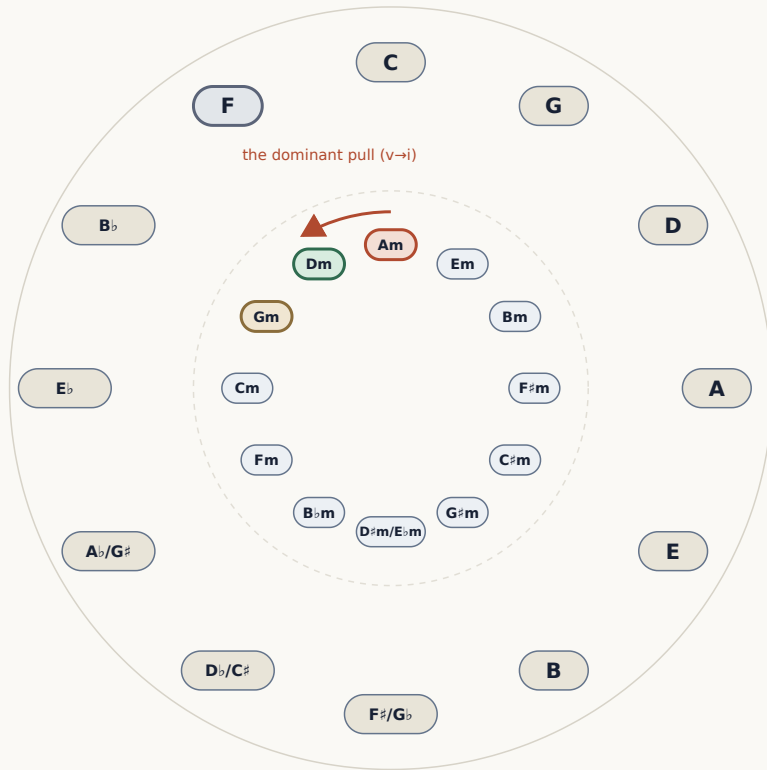
capo 3 + E minor shapes

(Em→Gm, G→Bb, A→C, Bm→Dm, C→Eb, D→F).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

Chord progressions in D minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of D minor is highlighted.

Diatonic chords in D minor

Functions: **i** · **iv**/**VI** · **v** · **III**

i · Dm tonic	ii° · Edim side	III · F rel. major	iv · G subdom.	v · Am minor dom.	VI · Bb subdom.	VII · C side
 Dm i · tonic	 Edim ii° · skip it take iv instead: G	 F III · rel. major	 G iv · subdom.	 Am v · minor dom.	 Bb VI · subdom.	 C VII · side

A7
the V7 pull (harmonic minor)
shape: x02020

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in D minor)

i - VI - III - VII

Dm - Bb - F - C

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

Dm - G - A7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - v

Dm - C - Bb - A

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

Dm - C - Bb - Am

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

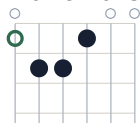
Dm - F - C - Bb

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

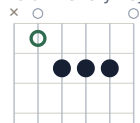
Dm7	Dm7	Dm7	Dm7	G7	G7	Dm7	Dm7	A7	G7	Dm7	A7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



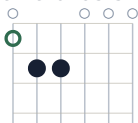
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



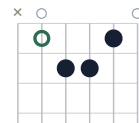
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of D minor:

No capo — Dm/F/G/Am/Bb/C mostly open shapes; otherwise capo 5 + A-minor shapes (Am→Dm)

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes